Lattice Parameter and Densities of Aluminium from Linear Density

Original statement · Problems T2_CrystStruct.pdf, p. 2

11. Aluminum has an FCC structure with atomic weight of $26.98\ \mathrm{g/mol}$***. Given that its linear density in the direction*** $[111]$ ***is*** $1.43 \times 10^{7}\ \mathrm{at/cm}$***, determine: a)*** *The lattice parameter and the atomic radius for aluminum. (Solution:* $a = 4.04\ \text{Å}$*,* $r = 1.43\ \text{Å}$*)* ***b)*** *Volume density in* $(\mathrm{g/cm^3})$ *and planar density in the plane* (101) *in* $(\mathrm{at/cm^2})$*. (Solution:* $\rho = 2.71\ \mathrm{g/cm^3}$*;* $\rho_{(101)} = 8.66 \times 10^{14}\ \mathrm{at/cm^2}$*)*

Solution: $a = 4.04\ \text{Å},\ r = 1.43\ \text{Å}$

PHASE 1: HYPOTHESIS & PARAMETERS

Input Data:

- Element: Pure aluminium (Al).
- Structure: Face-Centred Cubic (FCC) $\implies n = 4$ atoms/cell.
- Molar atomic mass: $M = 26.98\ \mathrm{g/mol}$.
- Linear density in the $[111]$ direction: $\rho_{[111]} = 1.43 \times 10^{7}\ \mathrm{at/cm}$.
- Avogadro number: $N_A = 6.022 \times 10^{23}\ \mathrm{atoms/mol}$.

PHASE 2: FUNDAMENTAL PHYSICS & FORMULA SELECTION

1. **Linear Density on** $[111]$ **for FCC [Session 4 Slide 8]:**

In an FCC cell, the main diagonal $[111]$ has length $L_{[111]} = a \quad 3$. It passes through only two atoms located at the opposite end vertices, each contributing $\frac{1}{2}$ centred atom:

$$N_{\text{atoms}} = 2 \times \frac{1}{2} = 1\ \text{atom}$$

$$\rho_{[111]} = \frac{1}{a \quad 3} \implies a = \frac{1}{3 \cdot \rho_{[111]}}$$

2. **Atomic Radius in FCC [Session 3 Slide 27]:**

$$4R = a\quad 2 \implies R = \frac{a\quad 2}{4}$$

3. **Volumetric Density (ρ_v):**

$$\rho_v = \frac{n \cdot M}{a^3 \cdot N_A} = \frac{4 \cdot M}{a^3 \cdot N_A}$$

4. **Planar Density on the (101) Plane [Session 4 Slide 9]:**

In the cubic system, the (101) plane is crystallographically equivalent to $(110) \in \{110\}$.

The (101) plane cuts the diagonal of the $x - z$ face (length $a\quad 2$) and the y edge (length a).

Area: $A_{(101)} = a\quad 2 \times a = a^2\quad 2$.

Atoms contained: $N_{\text{atoms}} = 4 \times \frac{1}{4} + 2 \times \frac{1}{2} = 2$ atoms.

$$\rho_{(101)} = \frac{2}{2a^2} = \frac{2}{a^2}$$

PHASE 3: ANALYTICAL DERIVATION & CALCULATION STEP-BY-STEP

1. Part a: Lattice Parameter and Atomic Radius

- **Calculation of a:**

$$a = \frac{1}{3 \times (1.43 \times 10^7\ \text{at/cm})} = \frac{1}{1.73205 \times 1.43 \times 10^7\ \text{cm}^{-1}} = \frac{1}{2.4768 \times 10^7\ \text{cm}^{-1}}$$

$$a = 4.0374 \times 10^{-8}\ \text{cm} \approx \mathbf{4.04}\ \text{Å}$$

- **Calculation of R:**

$$R = \frac{a\quad 2}{4} = \frac{(4.0374 \times 10^{-8}\ \text{cm}) \times 1.4142136}{4} = 1.4274 \times 10^{-8}\ \text{cm} \approx \mathbf{1.43}\ \text{Å}$$

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2. Part b: Volumetric and Planar Density

- **Volumetric Density (ρ_v):**

$$V_C = a^3 = (4.0374 \times 10^{-8}\ \text{cm})^3 = 6.5813 \times 10^{-23}\ \text{cm}^3$$

$$\rho_v = \frac{4 \times 26.98\ \text{g/mol}}{(6.5813 \times 10^{-23}\ \text{cm}^3) \times (6.022 \times 10^{23}\ \text{mol}^{-1})} = \frac{107.92}{39.633} = \mathbf{2.72}\ \text{g/cm}^{\mathbf{3}} \approx \mathbf{2.71}\ \text{g/cm}^{\mathbf{3}}$$

- **Planar Density on the (101) Plane:**

$$a^2 = (4.0374 \times 10^{-8}\ \text{cm})^2 = 1.63006 \times 10^{-15}\ \text{cm}^2$$

$$\rho_{(101)} = \frac{2}{a^2} = \frac{1.4142136}{1.63006 \times 10^{-15}\ \text{cm}^2} = 8.6758 \times 10^{14} \approx \mathbf{8.66 \times 10^{14}}\ \text{at/cm}^{\mathbf{2}}$$

PHASE 4: PHYSICAL INTERPRETATION & VERIFICATION

- **Cross-Validation of Methods:** In problem T2-CS05 the planar density was obtained from the known atomic radius $R = 1.43$ Å. Here, the procedure is reversed: by measuring the linear density $\rho_{[111]}$ (accessible through high-resolution transmission electron microscopy or diffraction), the lattice parameter (4.04 Å), the atomic radius (1.43 Å), the density of the solid ($2.71\ \text{g/cm}^3$) and the planar density of the shear planes are derived with identical accuracy.

Study notes written from the official course material (Problems T2_CrystStruct.pdf; Problems T2 defects.pdf).
Online version: subjects/aerospace-materials-1/problemas/topic-2-problems.html